Hill Health Navigators Collective

Neighbors helping neighbors get care

STATUS	501(c)(3) public charity, Connecticut
FOUNDED	2016
BASED IN	The Hill, New Haven (storefront on a main corridor)
SERVES	Adults in the Hill and nearby neighborhoods, especially uninsured or underinsured residents
ANNUAL BUDGET	About $310,000
STAFF	Director, 4 community health workers (CHWs), part-time data/admin assistant
VOLUNTEERS	About 8 (health fair helpers, interpreters)
REACH	About 900 people helped per year; 250 in ongoing CHW support

MISSION

We train and employ community health workers from the Hill to connect our neighbors to health coverage, care, and the everyday supports that keep people healthy.

OUR STORY

Started by a nurse practitioner and three neighborhood residents who were already the people others called for help with insurance forms. The collective now employs those residents as certified community health workers.

WHO WE SERVE

Working-age adults and families, many Spanish- or Haitian Creole-speaking, many managing diabetes or high blood pressure. Some are undocumented and fearful of formal systems.

PROGRAMS

Coverage Help
Walk-in and appointment help enrolling in Medicaid, the state marketplace, and other programs.

Chronic Care Companions
CHWs support people with diabetes or hypertension for six months: appointments, medications, food, and stress. Partnered with two primary care clinics.

Health on the Block
Monthly blood pressure checks and health information at barbershops, churches, and bodegas.

HOW WE'RE FUNDED

A contract with a health system's community benefit program (45%), state public health grant (25%), foundations (20%), and a hospital partner's in-kind space support (10%).

WHAT WE TRACK TODAY

A simple client database: contacts, enrollments, referrals. For Chronic Care Companions, CHWs record self-reported blood pressure and A1C when clinics share them, which is inconsistent.

WHAT WE'RE WRESTLING WITH

The health system funder wants evidence of fewer emergency room visits, which the collective can't see directly. Staff also want to capture what makes CHWs effective: trust, language, and lived experience.

A MOMENT FROM OUR WORK

A man who hadn't seen a doctor in nine years came in for a free blood pressure check at his barbershop. A CHW walked him to a clinic appointment the next week. Six months later he was bringing his brother to the same barbershop event. (Details changed to protect privacy.)